Occupational Health and Safety Policy

Richtlinie zu Arbeitsschutz und Gesundheitsschutz am Arbeitsplatz

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Owner	Carlos Mendes, Safety Officer (Fachkraft für Arbeitssicherheit)
Approved by	Anja Richter, COO
Consulted	Workplace Safety Committee (Arbeitsschutzausschuss); Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair (Betriebsrat); Dr. Sabine Lang, company physician (Betriebsärztin); Markus Vogel, Facilities Manager; Julia Neumann, HR Director
Applies to	All employees, trainees, working students and interns, as well as volunteers, contractors, consultants and temporary agency staff working at our sites (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt), remotely, in company vehicles and on business trips
Classification	Internal
Language	English. A German version is available from HR on request.

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1 Purpose

This Occupational Health and Safety Policy helps us preserve the best possible working conditions for our employees. Every employee has a right to feel safe at work. Norvane Systems is committed to following legal standards, in particular the Occupational Safety and Health Act (Arbeitsschutzgesetz, ArbSchG), the Occupational Safety Act (Arbeitssicherheitsgesetz, ASiG), the Workplace Ordinance (Arbeitsstättenverordnung, ArbStättV) and the accident prevention regulation DGUV Vorschrift 1, and to creating a workplace that is as free of hazards as reasonably possible.

2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Norvane Systems as well as to volunteers, contractors, consultants and temporary agency staff. It applies at all sites, in remote work, in company vehicles and on business trips. Visitors are covered by the rules in the Employee Code of Conduct (NS-HR-POL-001).

3 Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Managing Directors (Geschäftsführer) and COO	Overall responsibility for occupational health and safety; provide the necessary resources.
Safety Officer (Carlos Mendes)	Advises on risk assessments, inspections and training; chairs the Workplace Safety Committee (Arbeitsschutzausschuss), which meets quarterly.
Company physician (Dr. Sabine Lang)	Occupational health care, advice and preventive examinations; on site at HQ on Tuesdays.
Facilities Manager (Markus Vogel)	Maintenance and inspection of buildings, alarms, extinguishers, emergency lighting and escape routes.
Team leaders and line managers	Implement this policy in their teams, brief their employees (Unterweisung) and make sure rules are followed.
Safety representatives, first aiders and fire wardens	Support colleagues on site and report defects and hazards.
Works Council (Betriebsrat)	Co-determination and monitoring in occupational health and safety under the Works Constitution Act (BetrVG).
All employees	Follow health and safety instructions, use protective equipment and report hazards, accidents and near misses.

4 Preventative action

There are two aspects to our occupational health and safety programme: preventative action and emergency management. Preventative action is any action we take to avoid injuries or illness related to workplace conditions.

4.1 Risk assessment and hazards

We conduct periodic risk assessments (Gefährdungsbeurteilung) and job hazard analyses to discover what is likely to harm employees, and we establish preventative measures accordingly. Risk assessments are reviewed at least once a year and whenever workplaces, equipment or processes change.

Potential threats and dangerous situations include, but are not limited to, the following:

Hazard	Where it applies	Examples
Heights, ladders and unsteady structures	Garching, Frankfurt, all sites	Racking, ladders, platforms, cabling work.
Chemical substances (toxic, flammable)	Garching, Frankfurt	Cleaning agents, batteries, extinguishing agents.
Dangerous equipment	Garching	Forklifts and other industrial trucks, pallet trucks, company vehicles.
Slippery or uneven surfaces	All sites	Wet floors, cables, loading areas.
Electrical infrastructure	Frankfurt, all sites	Power distribution, UPS, chargers.
Noise and temperature	Frankfurt, Garching	Server halls, loading areas, unheated warehouse areas.
Air quality	All sites	Ventilation in offices and meeting rooms, exhaust fumes in the warehouse.
Display screen work (Bildschirmarbeit) and ergonomics	Munich, Berlin, home office	Posture, screen set-up, long periods of sitting, eye strain.
Psychological stress	All sites	Workload, on-call duty, shift work, harassment (see NS-HR-POL-003).

4.2 Preventative measures

We take the following preventative measures:

- When employees work in dangerous contexts or at dangerous locations, we make sure there are safety precautions such as fall protection (guard rails, safety harnesses and ropes).
- We provide protective gear such as gloves, protective clothing, goggles and safety shoes free of charge. Using safety equipment is obligatory.
- Technical inspectors and quality control staff inspect equipment and infrastructure regularly, including electrical equipment, ladders and industrial trucks, in line with legal inspection intervals.
- We hold employee training sessions on health and safety standards and procedures: at onboarding, before a new task begins, and at least once a year (annual safety briefing, Unterweisung).
- All highly dangerous job tasks require at least two employees to be present (no lone working).
- Exposure to hazardous substances (Gefahrstoffe) and to noise will not exceed the legal limits, and exposure time is limited where required.
- Employees who do repairs or cleaning must put up caution signs.
- We prohibit smoking indoors (see NS-EHS-POL-001).

- We provide ergonomic workstations and offer workstation checks, and we offer eye examinations for display screen work through the company physician.

We also enforce the Substance Abuse Policy (NS-EHS-POL-002) to protect employees from the risks caused by impairment. If you are in imminent and serious danger, you may stop work and leave the danger zone immediately, and you will not suffer any disadvantage for doing so.

5 Emergency management

Emergency management refers to our plan to deal with sudden events such as fire, flood, explosion, power failure or medical emergencies. These can be caused by human error or by natural forces. The detailed steps are set out in the Emergency and Evacuation Procedure (NS-EHS-PRC-001). Our emergency management includes the following provisions:

- Functional smoke alarms and fire protection systems that are regularly inspected under the responsibility of the Facilities Manager (Markus Vogel).
- Technicians (external or internal) who are available to repair leaks, damage and blackouts quickly.
- Fire extinguishers and other fire protection equipment that are easily accessible.
- An evacuation plan posted on the walls of each floor and available on the intranet.
- Fire escapes and safety exits that are clearly marked, lit and kept clear.
- Fully stocked first-aid kits at convenient locations, and trained first aiders on each site.

Assembly points:

Site	Assembly point
Munich HQ	Courtyard, north side
Berlin office	Front forecourt
Garching depot and warehouse	Parking area P2
Frankfurt data center	Gate A

We also schedule fire drills and emergency evacuations at least once a year at each site. We monitor the performance of health and safety procedures and revise them to ensure a higher level of protection.

6 Accidents, near misses and reporting

All accidents, near misses and unsafe conditions must be reported to your line manager and the Safety Officer (carlos.mendes@norvane.example, ext. 2400) on the same working day. Every first-aid treatment is entered in the first-aid record (Verbandbuch). Accidents that cause more than three days of incapacity for work, and commuting accidents, are reported by HR to the responsible accident insurance institution (Berufsgenossenschaft) as required by law. We analyse accidents and near misses in the Workplace Safety Committee to find out what went wrong and what must change.

7 Additional measures

We keep up with changes and actively promote health and safety. We will:

- update our policy according to changes in occupational health and safety legislation;

- use incentive actions for health and safety (for example presenting safety awards at our annual company event);
- analyse past incidents to discover what went wrong;
- maintain clear procedures for accident reporting (section 6);
- revise work procedures to make them safer.

We also consult experts, the accident insurance institution (Berufsgenossenschaft) and insurance representatives to ensure that we comply with national and international standards.

8 Disciplinary consequences

Every team leader is responsible for implementing this health and safety policy. Employees must follow health and safety instructions and will be held accountable when they do not. We will take disciplinary action, which can extend to termination of employment, when employees consistently disregard health and safety rules. Action follows German employment law and includes, as a rule, a formal warning (Abmahnung) first; the Works Council (Betriebsrat) is heard before any termination.

It is everyone's responsibility to contribute to a healthy and safe workplace.

9 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
Policy owner, safety questions, accident reports	Carlos Mendes, Safety Officer	carlos.mendes@norvane.example	2400
Occupational medicine	Dr. Sabine Lang, company physician	sabine.lang@norvane.example	2450
Buildings, alarms, defects	Markus Vogel, Facilities Manager	markus.vogel@norvane.example	6100
Accident insurance reports, HR	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Employee representation	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Emergency, building security (24/7)	Building security	security@norvane.example	9111

In an emergency call 112 (fire service and emergency services) or 110 (police).

10 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-EHS-PRC-001	Emergency and Evacuation Procedure	Emergency management (section 5)
NS-EHS-POL-001	Smoke-Free Workplace Policy	Smoking rules

NS-EHS-POL-002	Substance Abuse Policy	Alcohol, drugs and fitness for work
NS-HR-POL-003	Workplace Harassment Policy	Psychological stress and harassment
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies	Further workplace rules

11 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	01.03.2023	Carlos Mendes	First issue.
1.1	01.09.2024	Carlos Mendes	Added display screen work and home-office ergonomics.
2.0	01.06.2026	Carlos Mendes	Revised with the Workplace Safety Committee and the Works Council; responsibilities and site hazard tables added; accident reporting aligned with German law.

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